Section I

READING

Listen to the teacher read this section.

Once upon a time, on the **outskirts** of a dusty little village, a tiny bird searched for a place to lay her eggs. The land was **parched** and dry and there wasn't a bush or tree in sight. Finally in **desperation**, the little bird discovered a shallow depression in the ground. Using her claws to remove the stones and loosen up the packed earth, she broadened the hole and there, underneath the hot sun, she laid her eggs. The eggs hatched and the good mother protected and fed her babies until they were big enough to fly away... And here our story would have ended, except, this isn't a tale of the little bird but a much more interesting one of the hole she used as a temporary nest.



"A hole?" you may ask. "What could be interesting about a hole in the ground?" Well, this hole grew to be quite important, as you will discover.

For some time the hole remained dusty and **untenanted**, until one day a passing wild boar settled his **rump** into the depression. The pit was not comfortable enough and getting up, he scraped and dug, carving a pit of more hospitable proportions. Backing into this hollow, he turned around a few times and with a satisfied grunt settled down to a long snooze. A very long snooze it was too. The boar turned and **scrabbled** in his sleep, loosening the earth around his **cosy** dugout until the fading sun and the **rumble** in his stomach told him it was time to get up. With a mighty stretch and a final kick, the hungry boar departed his daybed without a backward glance.



"And is that it?" you will enquire. To which I will reply, "No it isn't, dear one. Not by a long shot. Our story has just begun."

GLOSSARY

outskirts	- the outer areas of a city or a town	scrabbled	- moved hands and feet around
parched	- very dry	cosy	- comfortable
desperation	- losing hope	rumble	- a low sound like thunder
untenanted	- not occupied		
rump	- back part of a mammal's body or the part of the body you use to sit		

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